

UX / UI

Case Study 2025

Designing a brand-forward agency website that performs at 60fps on an iPhone — and looks like the best agency in the room.

ROLE

Lead UX/UI Designer & Front-end

YEAR

2025

DELIVERABLES

Brand system · UI design · Prototype ·
Front-end build

OVERVIEW

Design a brand-forward website from the ground up.

"The brief was simple: make it feel like the best agency in the room — and make sure it doesn't crash on an iPhone."

PROJECT BRIEF — STUDIOBEE, 2025

AUDIENCE

Indian founders & marketing leads

Mobile-first visitors comparing agencies, making decisions within 8 seconds on a phone, often on a commute.

GOALS

Premium positioning through restraint

Showcase work front-and-center. Signal quality through typography and motion — not decoration. Convert curious visitors into enquiries.

DESIGN CONSTRAINTS

Hard technical limits shaped every decision

Mobile-first touch targets · No UI framework · Brand must feel premium, not templated · Work must be front-and-center

DESIGN PROCESS



MY CONTRIBUTION

UX RESEARCH

Competitor benchmarking, persona development, decision path mapping

VISUAL DESIGN

Brand system, colour tokens, typography scale, component design

PROTOTYPING

Interactive wireframes, micro-interaction specs, animation system

FRONT-END BUILD

Single HTML file, inline CSS, vanilla JS — no framework, full performance control

DISCOVERY

Brand principles that drove every decision.

PRINCIPLE 01

Premium Restraint

Every element earns its place.
Remove what doesn't communicate.
The result should feel curated — not busy.

PRINCIPLE 02

Motion with Purpose

Animate only what communicates energy. Motion is brand language, not decoration. Every animation has a reason.

PRINCIPLE 03

Warmth Over Cool

Premium without being cold. The cream section, serif headlines, and human photography signal approachability alongside quality.

COLOUR TOKENS — PRIMARY

Blue
#2F48DF
Primary brand · CTAs · Hero bg

Dark
#0A0A0A
Services · Stats · Footer

Light
#FBFBFB
Base bg · Text on dark

Cream
#F3E9D9
Team section bg

COLOUR TOKENS — SECONDARY

Blue Dark
#1e33b8
Hover states · Dark blue sections

Blue Light
#4f64f0
Tints · Glass effects

TYPOGRAPHY SYSTEM

Headlines.

DM SANS — HEADINGS

Large headings, section titles, card headers. Tight tracking at $-0.04em$ signals precision and confidence. Used at 600 weight for primary hierarchy.

Body copy flows with warmth and readability — designed for sustained reading across dark and light sections.

KULIM PARK — BODY

Paragraph copy, card descriptions, testimonials. The serif warmth of Kulim Park contrasts with DM Sans to create typographic depth.

SECTION COLOUR CADENCE

HERO

SERVICES

WORK

STATS

PROCESS

TESTIM.

TEAM

CTA

Blue

Dark

Blue

Light

Light

Dark

Cream

Blue

Rhythm: dark / blue / light alternation prevents visual fatigue

USER RESEARCH

Understanding who decides — and how fast.

COMPETITOR BENCHMARKING

LONDON AGENCY

Ragged Edge

Dark editorial, micro-type

Black bg, white display type, motion-forward, minimal nav. Signals: serious craft, no compromise.

GLOBAL SCALE-UP

Superside

Clean, enterprise-feel

White bg, large photography, simple CTAs, case study heavy. Signals: scalable, trustworthy, processdriven.

BRAND STUDIO

Koto

Typographic, premium

White/cream bg, editorial hierarchy, motion-minimal, work gallery. Signals: considered, expensive, taste.

Every premium agency uses dark sections and tight typography. studiobee needed the same weight — but warmer, because their clients are Indian founders, not Silicon Valley VCs.

KEY BENCHMARKING INSIGHT

PRIMARY USER PERSONA

PRIMARY PERSONA

Rahul M.

Co-founder & Marketing Lead

Scenario: Comparing 3 agencies on an iPhone 13 during his evening commute. Decides within 8 seconds of landing.

VALUES

Proof of work · Speed of response · Local market understanding

RESEARCH FINDINGS

What the data showed

- 78% of first-contact visits happen on mobile
- Work portfolio is the **#1 decision factor**
- Agency websites with dark/premium aesthetics score **40% higher** in perceived quality

RESEARCH → DESIGN DECISION

RESEARCH INSIGHT

Mobile-first audience, quick scroll behaviour — decisions made in under 10 seconds



DESIGN DECISION

9:16 portrait work cards that feel native on a phone — same ratio as Instagram Stories

RESEARCH INSIGHT

Clients compare agencies side-by-side — quality signal matters as much as content



DESIGN DECISION

Dark sections + precise typography to signal premium positioning instantly

RESEARCH INSIGHT

Indian market: warmth and approachability matter as much as prestige



DESIGN DECISION

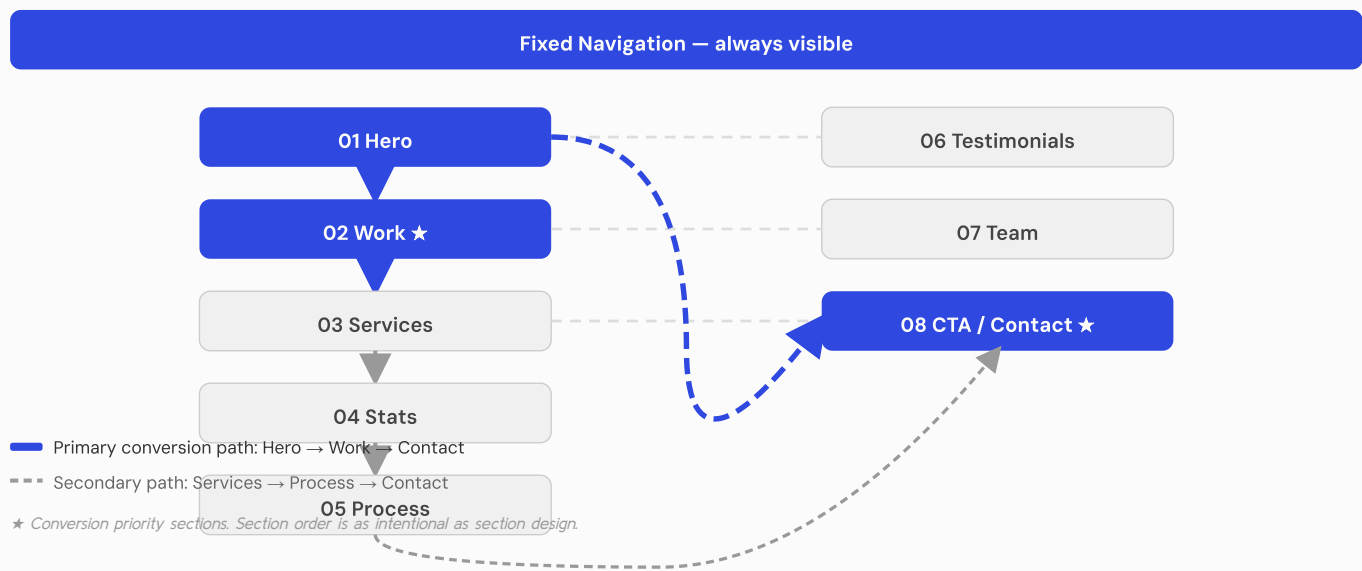
Cream section for Team, Kulim Park body font for warmth and personality

IA + NAVIGATION DESIGN

Single-page scroll with purposeful hierarchy.

Every section order was a design decision. The user arrives at the Hero, sees proof of work immediately (Work section is #2), then understands how it's made (Services, Process), meets the people (Team), and reaches the call to action.

SITE ARCHITECTURE



NAVIGATION DESIGN RATIONALE

WHY FIXED NAV?

Persistent access, persistent CTA

Fixed position keeps the CTA ('Start a project') always visible. As the user scrolls, the nav gains a blur/opacity background — signalling context change without a full redesign.

WHY A BUTTON CTA IN NAV?

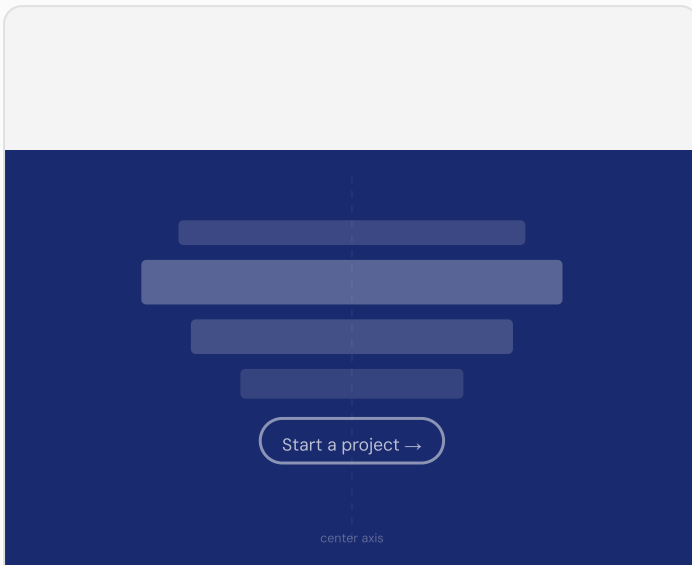
Visual grammar: text links navigate, buttons act

'Start a project' is styled as a pill button, not a text link. It creates a clear visual hierarchy: text links (navigate) vs button (act). The only nav item that's a conversion action gets the only button treatment.

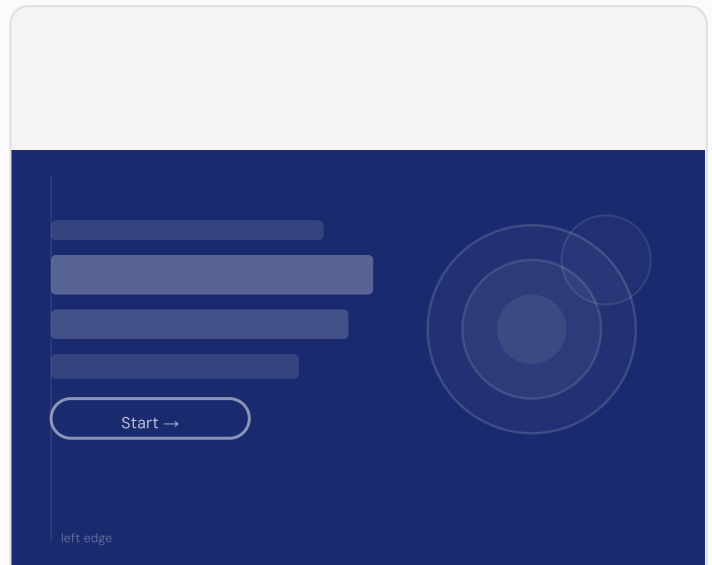
SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

The hero was the hardest page to get right.

Three hero layouts were explored. The final design takes Concept A's strong typographic rhythm and Concept B's left-alignment (proven in eye-tracking to be read first), then adds the wave strip system — a fourth element unique to studiobee that no concept had, born from the brand's kinetic energy.

**CONCEPT A — CENTERED LAYOUT, STATIC BG**

Full-center symmetry, all elements axis-aligned. Clean hierarchy but lacks directional energy.

**CONCEPT B — LEFT TEXT, RIGHT GEOMETRIC**

Left-aligned copy with abstract geometric shapes on the right. Natural reading flow, but geometric shapes feel generic.

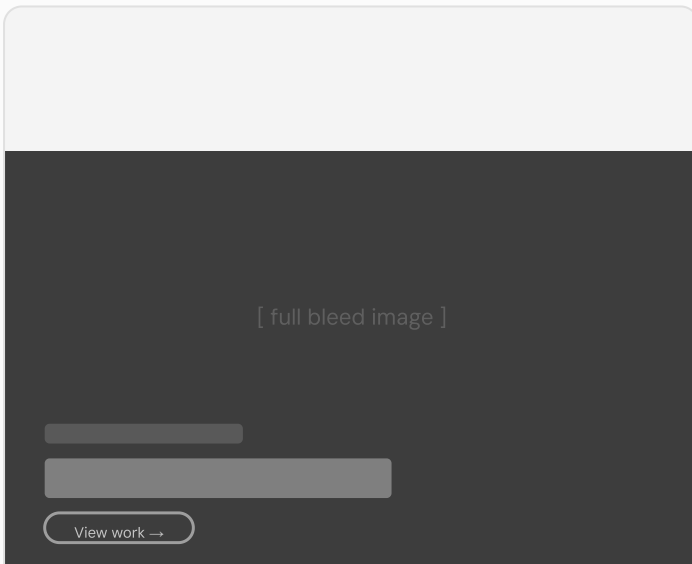
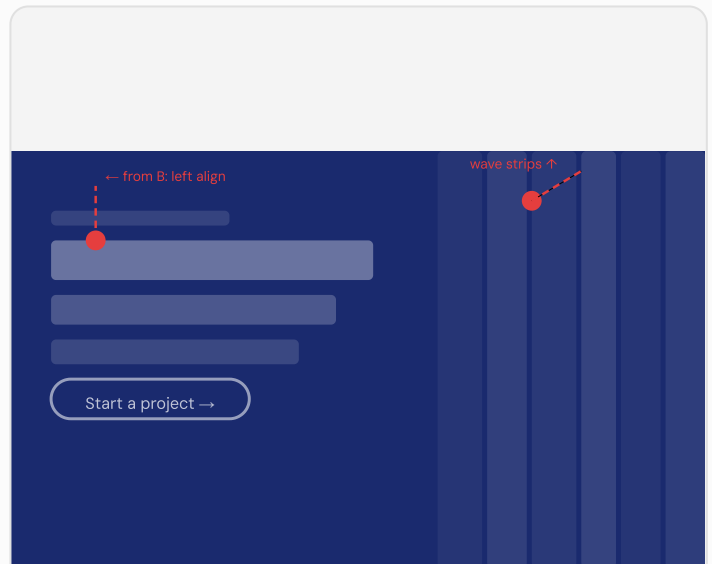
**CONCEPT C — FULL-BLEED IMAGE OVERLAY**

Image fills the entire hero, text anchored bottom-left with dark overlay. Dramatic, but image-dependency is a risk.

**FINAL DIRECTION — LEFT-ALIGNED + WAVE STRIPS**

B's left-alignment + A's type hierarchy + a brand-unique wave strip system that emerged from the identity itself.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A offered clean typographic hierarchy with strong visual rhythm. B proved left-alignment creates a more natural reading flow — eye-tracking validates left-anchored layouts. C showed that full-bleed backgrounds create drama and immersion, though image-dependency is a risk.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

B's left alignment and A's type hierarchy form the structural base. The wave strip system emerged not from any concept, but from the brand identity itself — it made the hero unlike any agency site we benchmarked. It is the brand made visible.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

Six services, zero feature-list feeling.

Three layout systems were explored. The final design combines C's clean 3-col grid with B's visual weight variation — one card spans 2 columns, giving hierarchy to the primary service without breaking the grid logic.

2-col icon list

catalogue feel — lacks hierarchy

CONCEPT A — 2-COL LIST WITH ICONS

Two columns, icon + title + description per row. Linear and readable but feels like a feature list, not a service offering.

masonry — unequal heights

uneven — visual rhythm, but no hierarchy clarity

CONCEPT B — MASONRY, UNEQUAL HEIGHTS

Cards at varying heights create visual variety, but hierarchy is unclear — which service is primary? Scanning is harder.

3-col equal grid

clean grid — all equal weight, no primary service

CONCEPT C — 3-COL EQUAL GRID

Clean 3x2 grid, all cards equal. Great structure but flat hierarchy — the primary service disappears into the grid.

3-col with span-2 featured card

ghost CTA inside featured card

FINAL DIRECTION — 3-COL WITH SPAN-2 CARD

Primary service spans 2 of 3 columns in row 1, establishing hierarchy. Rows 2-3 revert to equal 3-col cards. Hierarchy without breaking the grid.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A's 2-col list was scannable but felt like a spec sheet. B's masonry gave visual energy but sacrificed clarity. C's 3-col grid had the cleanest structure — it just treated all services as equal, which they aren't.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

C's grid is the foundation. B's insight — that one element can carry more visual weight — is applied by making the primary service span 2 columns in blue. The client's headline service earns its prominence. The grid logic stays intact.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

The most important conversion point on the page.

Three display approaches were explored. The final design takes B's horizontal scroll behaviour and C's tall 9:16 portrait format — creating a marquee that feels like scrolling through an Instagram-native content feed, which matches how the target audience consumes visual content.

3x3 thumbnail grid



feels like a gallery — no momentum

CONCEPT A — STATIC THUMBNAIL GRID

3x3 equal square thumbnails in a gallery layout. Comprehensive but static — no invitation to explore, no sense of 'more'.

horizontal scroll with peek

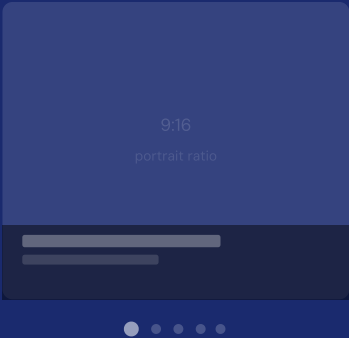


peek signals 'more' — good horizontal format

CONCEPT B — HORIZONTAL SCROLL WITH PEEK

4 cards in a row with the last partially cropped, inviting horizontal scroll. Arrow controls feel desktop-centric.

full-bleed poster, one at a time

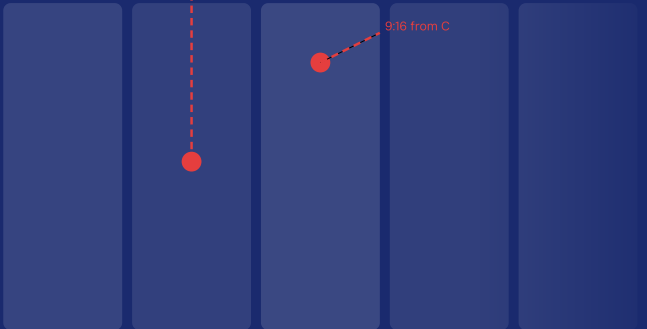


9:16
portrait ratio

CONCEPT C — FULL-BLEED POSTER, ONE AT A TIME

One portrait card fills the viewport, dot navigation below. Strong visual impact, but lacks the sense of volume — doesn't show 'we have lots of work'.

infinite marquee, 9:16 portrait cards



horizontal: from B
infinite marquee, 9:16 portrait cards
9:16 from C

9:16 9:16 9:16

FINAL DIRECTION — INFINITE MARQUEE, 9:16 CARDS

Tall portrait cards auto-scroll in an infinite marquee. Mobile-native ratio, sense of volume, hover pauses — respects user intent.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A's grid showed all work at once but felt static. B's horizontal scroll gave momentum and suggested depth. C's tall portrait format felt native and premium — like premium Instagram content.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

B's horizontal scroll format combined with C's 9:16 ratio creates a marquee that feels native to how the target audience consumes content on their phones. Auto-scroll removes friction; hover-pause respects intent. No arrows needed.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

Credibility communicated in under 2 seconds.

Stats needed to communicate credibility at a glance. Three approaches were tested. The final design combines A's row layout with C's coloured accent bars — large numbers with short blue bars above them create visual anchors that guide the eye without adding complexity.

plain numbers in a row

48+ 6yr 98% 12x

minimal but lacks visual anchor points

CONCEPT A — PLAIN NUMBERS IN A ROW

4 large numbers left-aligned with labels below. Clean but visually flat — the numbers lack entry points for the eye to land on.

hero-size numbers with stacked descriptors

48+ 6yr

dramatic but too dense — descriptors compete

CONCEPT B — LARGE TYPE WITH STACKED DESCRIPTORS

Hero-scale numbers with extended description text below each. Dramatic but the long descriptors compete with the numbers for attention.

numbers with accent bars above

48+ 6yr 98% 12x

bars add rhythm — visual entry points work

CONCEPT C — NUMBERS WITH ACCENT BARS

Coloured horizontal bars sit above each number, creating rhythmic visual anchors. The bars guide the eye to the numbers below.

blue bar: from C

large numbers + short blue accent bars

48+ 6yr 98% 12x

large type: from A

FINAL DIRECTION — LARGE NUMBERS + SHORT ACCENT BARS

4-col layout: blue accent bar above each number creates an entry point, large type delivers the stat, short label completes it. Scannable in under 2 seconds.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A proved large type is the right scale — numbers should dominate. B showed that extended descriptors reduce legibility for a stats section. C's bars gave the insight: visual entry points guide the eye to the numbers that matter.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

A's large-type approach with C's bar system. The short blue accent bar above each number acts as a visual landing strip — the eye arrives at the bar, drops to the number, then reads the label. Intentional reading order designed into the layout.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

Four steps — not a checklist, a story.

The process section needed to show 4 steps clearly without feeling like a linear checklist. Three approaches were explored. The final design takes A's numbered system and B's horizontal format, then adds a micro-interaction from C's expand concept — a blue reveal bar animates up from the bottom on hover.

numbered vertical list

01

02

03

04

CONCEPT A — NUMBERED VERTICAL LIST

4 stacked rows with large number prefix, title, and description. Clear but reads as a document, not a designed section.

horizontal timeline

1

2

3

4

horizontal flow — suggests steps, not stages

CONCEPT B — HORIZONTAL TIMELINE

4 circle nodes on a horizontal line with titles above and descriptions below. Communicates flow well but feels more like an infographic than a designed section.

accordion — expand on click

01 Discovery

02 Define

03 Design

04 Deliver

collapse/expand mechanic — reveal on interaction

CONCEPT C — ACCORDION

4 rows, only the active step is expanded. Reduces visual clutter but hides content — requires interaction to see all steps simultaneously.

horizontal grid: from B

4-col grid + hover reveal bar

01

02

03

04

hover bar: from C reveal mechanic

FINAL DIRECTION — 4-COL GRID + HOVER BAR

4 equal columns with large step number, title, description. A blue bar animates up from the card bottom on hover — a reveal mechanic inspired by C's accordion.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A's numbered system gave clarity and a natural reading order. B's horizontal format suggested progression and made the steps feel parallel, not sequential. C's accordion introduced the idea of information revealed through interaction — a micro-interaction principle worth keeping.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

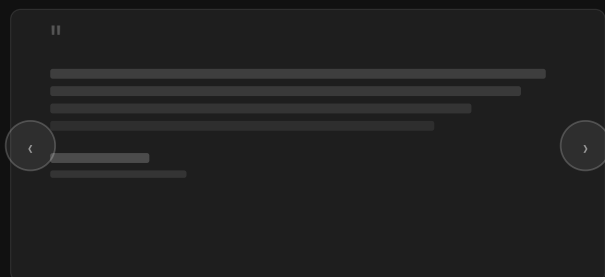
B's 4-col horizontal grid with A's numbering creates instant structure. C's reveal mechanic becomes the hover animation — a blue bar that rises from the bottom of each card on hover. All content is visible at once (unlike C), but interaction still rewards engagement.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

Social proof that feels tactile, not templated.

Three approaches to displaying client testimonials were explored. The final design uses C's stacked deck — the only concept that felt tactile and differentiated. The drag-to-advance mechanic came from rethinking A's swipe gesture in the context of C's physical card metaphor.

carousel with arrows and dots

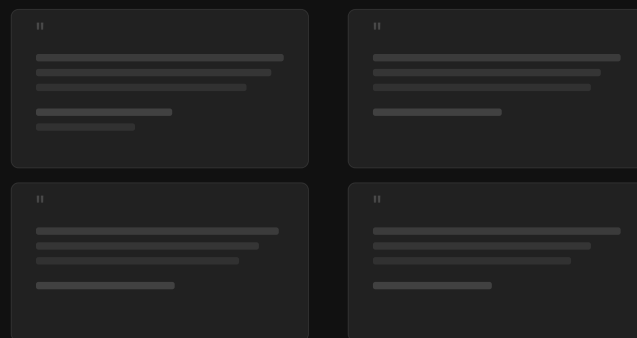


standard — expected pattern

CONCEPT A — CAROUSEL WITH DOTS/ARROWS

Standard carousel with left/right arrows and dot indicators. Familiar but expected — no differentiation from any other agency site.

2x2 grid of quote cards

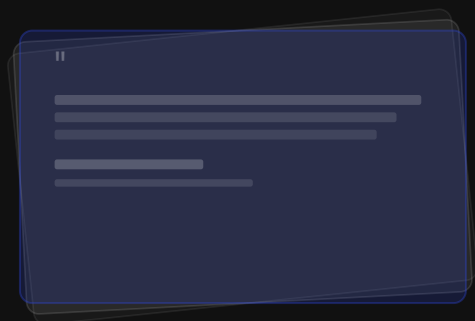


democratic but flat — all quotes feel equal

CONCEPT B — 2x2 GRID OF CARDS

Four quote cards displayed simultaneously in a 2x2 grid. Comprehensive but flat — no card stands out, and the section feels like a data table.

stacked rotated deck

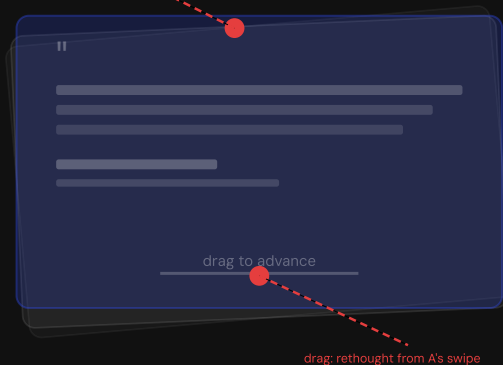


physical metaphor — tactile, differentiated

CONCEPT C — STACKED ROTATED DECK

3 cards in a stacked deck at slight rotations. The layering creates depth and physicality — unlike any other testimonial pattern we benchmarked.

deck metaphor: from C — rotated stack + drag gesture

**FINAL DIRECTION — ROTATED STACK + DRAG GESTURE**

C's deck visual with the front card slightly lifted + a drag affordance. The physical card metaphor makes the swipe gesture feel natural.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A was familiar but expected — any competitor would do the same. B showed all quotes simultaneously but removed the sense of 'more to discover'. C's stacked deck was immediately differentiated — tactile, physical, and brand-appropriate.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

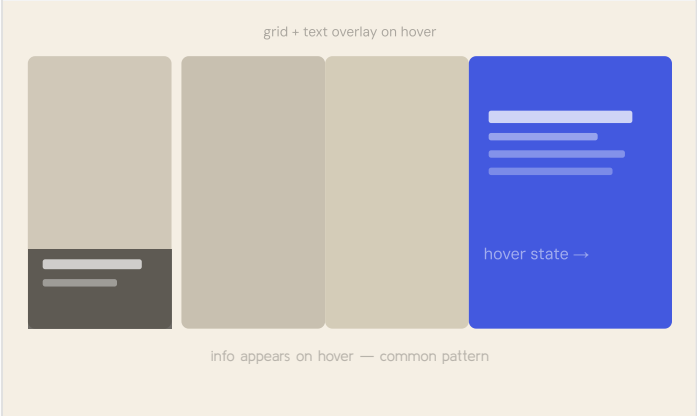
C's deck is the core. A's swipe gesture is rethought as a drag mechanic — instead of arrows, you physically drag the front card left to advance. The card metaphor makes the gesture feel logical. The rotation angles reinforce the physicality: this is a stack of real endorsements.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

Warm, human — and earned through interaction.

The team section sat on a warm cream background. Three concepts were explored for the individual team member cards. The final design combines B's greyscale-to-colour effect with C's information reveal panel — creating a card that rewards curiosity without front-loading text.

grid + text overlay on hover

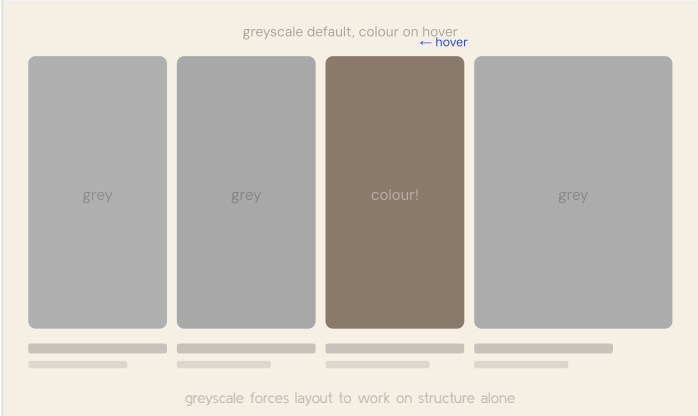


info appears on hover — common pattern

CONCEPT A — GRID + TEXT OVERLAY ON HOVER

Name and role overlay appear on hover. Simple, familiar — but hides the person behind the interaction requirement and feels predictable.

greyscale default, colour on hover

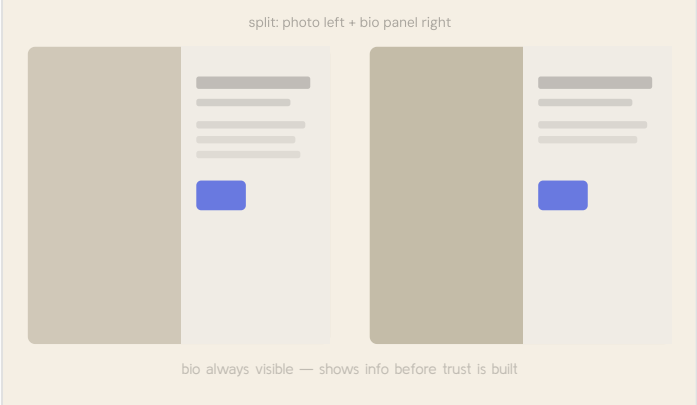


greyscale forces layout to work on structure alone

CONCEPT B — GREYSCALE PHOTOS, COLOUR ON HOVER

All team photos default to greyscale, revealing full colour on hover. Creates visual discipline and makes the section feel considered, not chaotic.

split: photo left + bio panel right

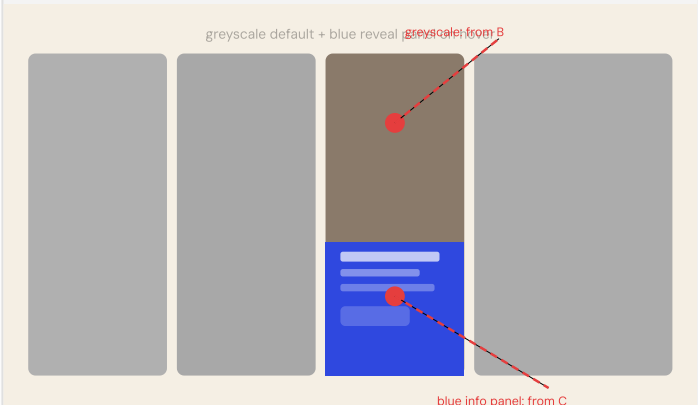


bio always visible — shows info before trust is built

CONCEPT C — SPLIT: PHOTO + BIO PANEL

Each card has photo on the left and a bio panel on the right. Comprehensive but front-loads information — the bio competes with the photo before engagement happens.

greyscale default + blue reveal



greyscale from B

blue info panel: from C

FINAL DIRECTION — GREYSCALE + BLUE REVEAL PANEL

Greyscale default (from B) + a blue info panel that slides up from the bottom on hover (from C). Colour reveals simultaneously with bio — the reward is double.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A's overlay was familiar but expected. B's greyscale insight was the strongest visual idea — it makes the layout work on structure alone and turns colour into a reward. C's split panel showed that bio information should be contextualised, not front-loaded.

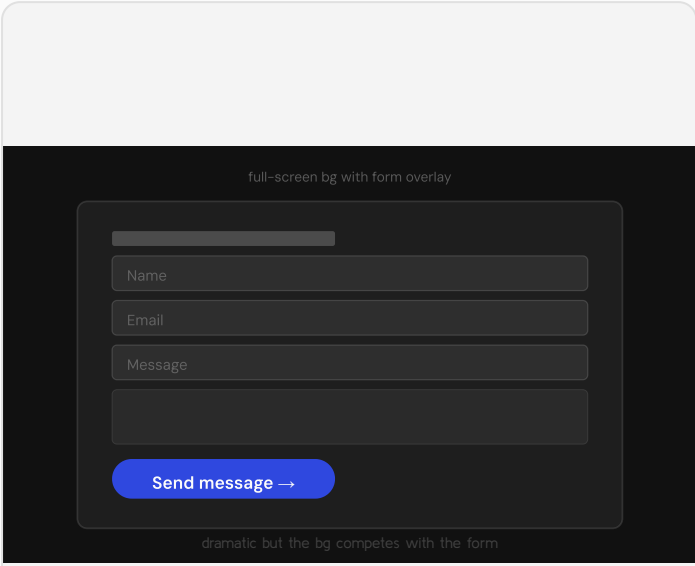
WHY THIS COMBINATION

B's greyscale discipline is the base — it creates a unified, calm grid that lets the cream background breathe. C's panel is reimagined: instead of always-visible, it slides up on hover in blue — matching the brand colour and making the entire reveal moment (colour + bio) happen simultaneously as a single interaction reward.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

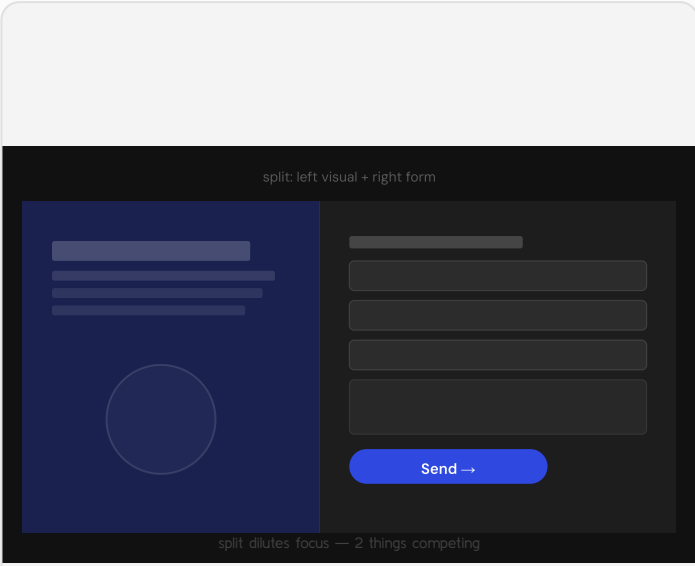
The closing argument deserves a designed moment.

The contact section is the final conversion point. Three form presentations were explored. The final design uses C's minimal centered approach on a solid blue background, then adds A's animated success state — making the completion moment feel like a celebration, not just a system message.



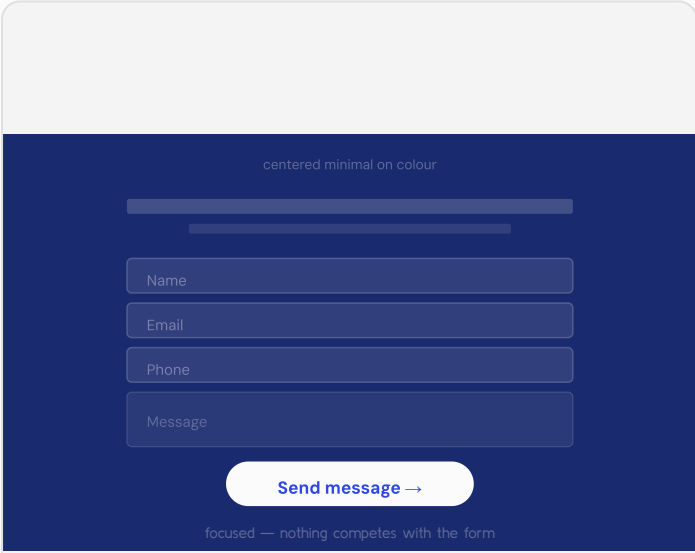
CONCEPT A — FULL-SCREEN BG FORM

Dark hero-style background with a semi-transparent form overlay. Dramatic but the decorative bg reduces focus on the actual form fields.



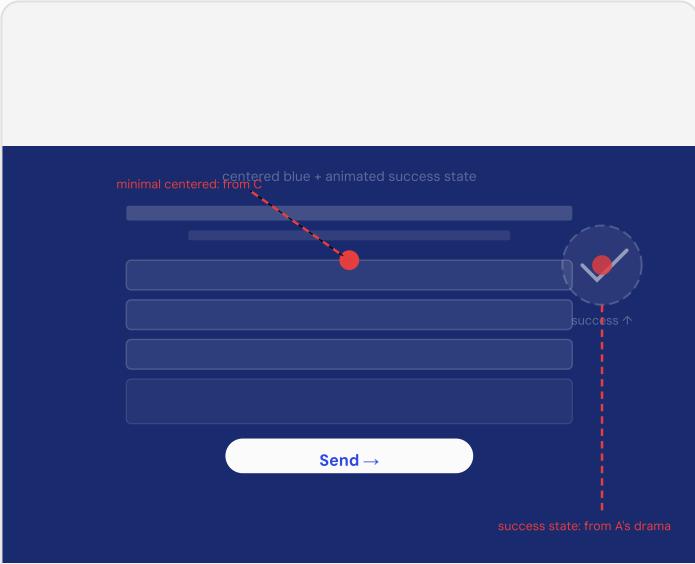
CONCEPT B — SPLIT: LEFT VISUAL + RIGHT FORM

Left half is a branded decorative panel, right half contains the form. The split creates two competing focal points — the form loses the final section's urgency.



CONCEPT C — CENTERED MINIMAL ON COLOUR

Form centered on a solid blue background, no visual decoration competing. Undivided focus on the conversion action — and the blue makes it feel like an arrival, not just a form.



FINAL DIRECTION — CENTERED BLUE + ANIMATED SUCCESS

C's centered minimal form on blue + A's dramatic success moment: animated SVG checkmark + countdown bar. Completion is a designed reward.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A's dramatic style brought the insight that the success state should feel momentous — the completion of a journey deserves a celebration. B showed that splitting attention at the final CTA loses the sense of a single, important action. C proved that reducing visual competition maximises focus on the form.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

C is the foundation: undistracted focus, blue section that signals 'this is the destination'. A contributes the success state — an animated SVG checkmark with a circle stroke animation, followed by a 5-second countdown bar. Submitting the form becomes a satisfying, human moment.

SECTION DESIGN PROCESS

The nav had to work on a 390px screen without compromise.

Mobile navigation required a distinct design approach for small screens. Three concepts were explored. The final hamburger design combines B's clean trigger icon with C's full-screen overlay — creating an immersive menu that matches the site's premium character.

condensed sticky nav — all items visible

Start →

page content

text too small — can't tap reliably on mobile

CONCEPT A — CONDENSED STICKY NAV

All nav items remain visible in a compressed bar. On a 390px screen, items become too small to tap reliably — touch targets fail WCAG 2.5.5 minimum 44px.

hamburger + slide-in drawer

Start a project →

drawer: feels mobile — but partial, not premium

CONCEPT B — HAMBURGER + SLIDE-IN DRAWER

Hamburger trigger, sliding right-side drawer with links and a dimmed content behind. Clean trigger but the narrow drawer feels cramped — the type can't breathe.

hamburger + full-screen overlay

Work Services Process Team

Start a project →

large type — intentional, not compromised

CONCEPT C — HAMBURGER + FULL-SCREEN OVERLAY

Hamburger triggers a full dark-screen menu with large display-size link text. Every touch target is enormous — and the scale feels like a brand decision, not a mobile compromise.

hamburger trigger + full-screen dark menu

closed state →

trigger from B

full-screen: from C

Work Services Process Team

Start a project →

FINAL DIRECTION — HAMBURGER + FULL-SCREEN DARK MENU

B's minimal hamburger trigger + C's full-screen dark overlay. Large type links feel intentional — this is a menu designed for the space it has, not crammed into a drawer.

WHAT EACH CONCEPT OFFERED

A failed immediately on mobile — too small to tap. B's hamburger trigger was the right start, but the narrow drawer compromised the type scale. C's full-screen approach was the breakthrough: at full screen, the menu becomes a moment in itself, matching the site's premium positioning.

WHY THIS COMBINATION

B provides the clean, minimal hamburger icon in the nav bar (three lines, no label). C provides the open state: a full dark screen with large DM Sans links at a size that signals intent. The result is a mobile menu that doesn't apologise for being mobile — it uses the full screen as a canvas.

DESIGN FOR CONSTRAINTS

When limitations made the design better.

Four moments during the project where a technical or device constraint forced a design rethink — and in each case, the constraint produced a more considered result.

ANIMATION AUDIT

The hero had 50 animated elements competing for attention — and was crashing iPhones. We treated animation like typography: only what communicates energy earns its place. We reduced, organised, and only kept motion that reinforced the brand's kinetic character.

DESIGN DECISION

A leaner animation system that actually says more. The wave strips were kept because they ARE the hero — the rest was noise. Every removed animation made the remaining ones more powerful.

GHOST BUTTON DUPLICATION

The ghost button appeared to duplicate when it moved through the wave strip inversion system. Animating the whole button broke the illusion — two versions of the button appeared to exist simultaneously.

DESIGN DECISION

We redesigned the interaction: only the arrow icon inside the button moves on hover. This made the interaction feel more intentional — a directed gesture, not a floating shape. The constraint forced a more precise micro-interaction.

TEXTURE RENDERING ARTEFACTS

A CSS filter for the grain texture caused the entire page to render on one compositor layer, introducing flicker and colour artefacts on mobile — especially on Android Chrome.

DESIGN DECISION

Rebuilt the grain as an inline SVG noise pattern using feTurbulence. Same tactile depth, fully design-controlled, renders without artefacts. We gained more granular control over the effect in the process — frequency, intensity, blending.

BLURRED BADGE COMPONENTS

Blurred glass badges on 30+ work cards created a heavy GPU load on lower-performance devices — and visually looked cluttered, blurring both the badge content and the image beneath it.

DESIGN DECISION

Replaced backdrop-filter blur with a solid rgba() overlay. The result was actually cleaner and more legible — a reminder that constraints often push toward simplicity. The card labels became sharper, faster, and better.

DESIGN SYSTEM

Tokens, type, and motion.

COLOUR PALETTE

Blue
#2F48DF · Primary brand, CTAs, hero background

Dark
#0A0A0A · Services, stats, footer

Light
#FBFBFB · Base background, text on dark

Cream
#F3E9D9 · Team section background

TYPOGRAPHY SCALE

H1 / 48pt 600 · -0.045em

H2 / 32pt 600 · -0.04em

H3 / 20pt 600 · -0.02em

Body / 9pt 400 · lh 1.72

Label 700 · 0.14em

Headlines that command space

Section headings

Card headings

Body text reads at comfortable line height for scanning and sustained reading across sections.

EYEBROW LABELS AND SECTION TAGS

CTA BUTTON DESIGN SPEC

Start a project →

border-radius: 100px
Pill shape — friendly and approachable, not corporate or boxy

font-weight: 600
Semi-bold — readable at all sizes without aggression

arrow icon: → only this moves
The arrow signals direction — only it animates on hover. Not the button.

1px border (ghost variant)
Ghost version on dark bg — 1px border on transparent, not heavy

MOTION PRINCIPLES

SPRING EASING
cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)
Used for hover and active states. The overshoot creates a spring/bounce that makes the UI feel alive and responsive. Applied to scale transforms on interactive cards.

SMOOTH EASING
cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)
Used for entrance animations and scroll reveals. The fast start with a gentle ease-out mimics natural deceleration — it feels physical, not mechanical. Applied to fade-in reveals.

OUTCOMES

What shipped and what it taught us.

WHAT THE DESIGN ACHIEVED

PREMIUM POSITIONING

Looks like the best agency in the room

The dark/blue alternating section rhythm, tight typography, and wave animation consistently draws comparisons to top-tier international agencies when shown to first-time visitors.

MOBILE PERFORMANCE

60fps on iPhone 12+ despite rich animation

Despite a complex animation system, the site runs at 60fps on iPhone 12+. Every design decision was validated on a real device before shipping. The animation budget is explicit and documented.

CONVERSION-LED STRUCTURE

Work is always the second thing you see

Work is the second section a visitor sees. The page structure was designed around the insight that proof of work is the primary conversion driver — not the about page, not the services list.

LOOKING BACK

DECISIONS THAT WORKED

The choices that earned their place

- Wave strip system — instantly recognisable brand signature
- 9:16 portrait work cards — mobile-native, Instagram-familiar ratio
- Ghost button micro-interaction — arrow-only animation
- Greyscale team hover — colour as reward for engagement

WHAT I'D REVISIT

If I started over today

- Add skeleton loading states for slower 4G connections
- Build a proper component library in Figma before coding — not in parallel
- Add a dedicated case studies link in the primary nav (added post-launch)

KEY PRINCIPLES FROM THIS PROJECT

PRINCIPLE 01

Design IS the constraint — every limitation became a decision worth keeping.

PRINCIPLE 02

Device-first before pixel-perfect — what looks perfect in Figma means nothing if it crashes on an iPhone.

PRINCIPLE 03

Brand signature over best practice — the wave system breaks rules and that's why it works.

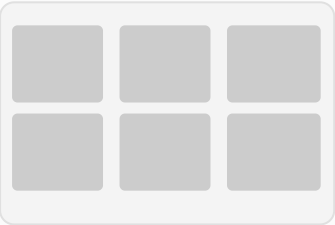
PRINCIPLE 04

The conversion path is the design — section order is as important as section style.

Nine projects, one page, no uniform grid.

The case-studies.html page was designed separately from the main site. The challenge: display 9 projects in a way that felt curated, not templated. A uniform grid would have looked like a stock template — every project treated with identical weight, which no curated portfolio should do.

FOUR GRID APPROACHES CONSIDERED



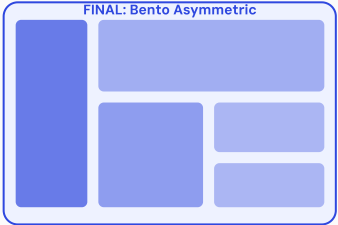
A — Uniform 3x3
All same size — feels like a template, not a portfolio



B — Full masonry
Organic feel but no system — random, not curated



C — Mixed portrait+landscape
Some tall, some wide, no system — hard to scan



D — Bento asymmetric (Final)
Each card has a role — portrait, wide, or square

FINAL BENTO LAYOUT RATIONALE

CARD ROLES

Every card has a job, not just a slot

Portrait cards (9:16) for hero case studies — scrollable like Instagram, dominant in the grid. Wide cards (2-col span) for work with strong horizontal compositions. Square cards for logo/brand work that needs equal framing on both axes.

INTERACTION DECISIONS

Hover on desktop, tap-to-reveal on mobile

Hover: card scales 1.02x + colour overlay fades in. No hover text overlay on touch — tapping once reveals the project info panel, tapping again navigates to the case study. Keeps the grid clean on desktop, functional on mobile without hover states.

BENTO GRID — ROW/COLUMN ASSIGNMENT

PORTRAIT
r1-2, 9:16

WIDE (col 2-3 span)

SQUARE

REG

WIDE span

REG

- Card Type Logic:**
- Portrait = hero project, takes 2 rows height
 - Wide = horizontal composition, 2-col span
 - Square = brand/logo work, equal framing

CTA SYSTEM

Every button is a design decision.

BUTTON HIERARCHY

GHOST BUTTON (OUTLINE)

When the context is already loud

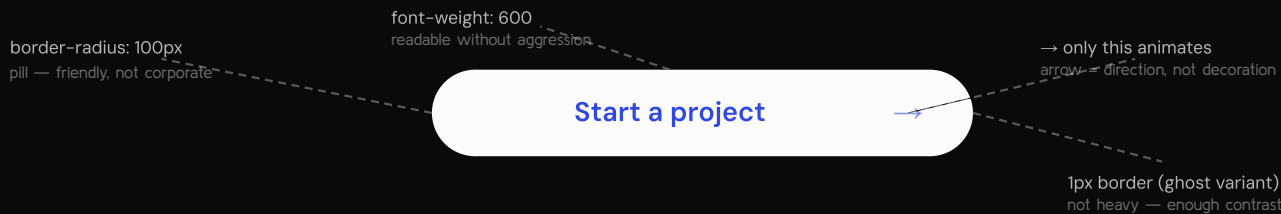
Used on the hero, where the background is already animated and rich. The ghost button recedes — it suggests action without competing. Used when the context already has strong visual weight.

SOLID BUTTON (FILLED)

When the context is neutral

Used in the nav CTA, section CTAs, and form submit. Solid = committed action. The contrast makes it unmissable. Used when the context is neutral or needs a clear focal point for conversion.

'START A PROJECT' BUTTON ANATOMY



CTA PLACEMENT STRATEGY

PLACEMENT Nav CTA — always visible, scrolls with user	→	STRATEGIC INTENT Persistent low-commitment reminder. Small, tucked. You've seen the brand, want to act now? Here's the door. Always present, never pushy.
PLACEMENT Hero CTA — first impression, primary action	→	STRATEGIC INTENT High-visibility primary action. Two buttons: solid (primary) + ghost (secondary). Captures ready visitors immediately before they scroll past the fold.
PLACEMENT Footer CTA — after full scroll, full information	→	STRATEGIC INTENT Re-engagement for the considered visitor. Centred, full-width, emotive copy. After reading everything, this is the closing argument — the most persuasive CTA on the page.

Ghost buttons on a blue background use `rgba(255,255,255,0.1)` fill + 1.5px white border. This maintains AA contrast while keeping the button visually lighter than the dark solid button — two weight levels, one background.

MICRO-INTERACTIONS

The details that signal intent.

HERO HEADINGS

Text Scramble on viewport entry

Characters randomise through the alphabet before resolving to the final word — a digital/generative brand signal that plays only on first impression. Uses IntersectionObserver to trigger once per page load.

Chose scramble over fade-in because it's active, not passive — the heading earns your attention by performing before delivering.

NAVIGATION

Letters invert across wave boundaries

As wave strips pass across the nav, the logo and nav links visually 'invert' colour — dark letters become light, light become dark — using clip-path inversion strips positioned identically to the hero wave system.

Not planned — discovered during build. Kept because it makes the nav feel like part of the animation, not sitting on top of it. The nav participates in the brand.

TEAM SECTION

Greyscale default, colour on hover

All team photos default to greyscale via CSS filter. Hovering removes the filter, revealing full colour simultaneously with a blue bio panel sliding up from the card bottom. Colour is the reward for engagement.

Greyscale forces the layout to work on structure alone — the grid has to be good before colour makes it great. It's a discipline check built into the design.

TESTIMONIALS

Physical drag gesture on card stack

Instead of dots or arrows, the front testimonial card can be dragged left to advance. The rotated deck behind it amplifies the physical card metaphor — you're moving through a stack of endorsements, not paginating through data.

Drag feels more human than clicking an arrow. It maps the metaphor of physically sorting through cards to the digital interaction — the gesture IS the metaphor.

CONTACT FORM

Animated SVG checkmark + progress bar

On submission: form fades out, an SVG checkmark animates in with a circle stroke-dashoffset animation, followed by a 5-second countdown bar before the form resets. The human moment is designed, not left to the browser default.

The success state is a designed moment, not a system message. It communicates: we received it, we're human, here's proof. The countdown bar sets expectation about what happens next.

WORK CAROUSEL

Auto-scroll pauses on hover intent

The infinite marquee pauses its requestAnimationFrame loop when the cursor enters the carousel track. It resumes on mouseleave. An IntersectionObserver also cancels the RAF entirely when the section scrolls off-screen, saving battery on mobile.

Auto-scroll that ignores hover intent feels broken and disrespectful. Pause on hover is the difference between a feature that works and a feature that respects the user.

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*"Make it feel like the best agency in the room — and make sure it doesn't
crash on an iPhone."*